

Office Shortcut and Product Trap Lab — Detailed Lecture Notes

JKSSB Computer Awareness

October 8, 2026

54.1 Why this lesson is a trap drill

The computer section of JKSSB papers does not reward vague recognition. It tests the **exact key** and the **exact product category**. A wrong option is usually not random; it is the nearest neighbour to the right answer — the key that differs by one letter, the same function key in a different program, or a familiar software name placed in the wrong category. The safe method is to read every option as a claim to be tested and to keep the exact English term: **F5**, **F7**, **Ctrl+H**, **\$A\$1**. This lesson gathers the Word, PowerPoint, Excel, and product-category traps that JKSSB reuses.

54.2 MS Word: exact shortcut keys

Word has a small set of shortcuts that JKSSB asks again and again. Learn each key with its full action.

Shortcut	Action in MS Word
F7	Spelling & Grammar (spell check)
Shift+F7	Thesaurus
Ctrl+H	Find and Replace
Ctrl+F	Find only (opens the Navigation pane)
Ctrl+K	Insert Hyperlink
Ctrl+X	Cut the selection
Ctrl+C	Copy the selection
Ctrl+V	Paste the Clipboard contents

Definition (Find and Replace). *A Word tool, opened with **Ctrl+H**, that searches for a word or phrase and replaces it with another across the document.*

The one distinction to fix first is **Ctrl+H** versus **Ctrl+F**. **Ctrl+H** opens Find and Replace, so it can change text; **Ctrl+F** only finds text. The second is **F7** versus **Shift+F7**: **F7** checks spelling and grammar, while **Shift+F7** opens the Thesaurus. A third is **Ctrl+K**, which inserts a hyperlink, not a comment or a caption.

54.3 Word views and review tools

Word offers several views of the same document. **Print Layout** shows the document exactly as it will appear on the printed page, with margins, headers, and footers in place. The other common

views are Web Layout, Outline, and Draft. For exam purposes, the key phrase “as it will appear when printed” points to Print Layout.

Track Changes is Word’s review tool. When it is switched on, every insertion, deletion, and formatting change is recorded rather than applied silently. Each marked change can later be **accepted** or **rejected** by a reviewer. Track Changes also stores the author’s name and the time of the edit as document metadata. The important trap is that Track Changes does *not* delete the original text permanently: the original remains available until a reviewer accepts or rejects the change (PYQ-12).

Example 54.3.1. *A candidate reads the option “Track Changes permanently deletes the original text, so it can never be restored.” This is false. Track Changes preserves the original text and marks the edit; the reviewer decides whether to accept or reject it. The trap works because “records changes” sounds close to “deletes the old version.”*

54.4 Word: Section Break versus Page Break

A **Page Break** starts a new page but keeps the document in the same section. A **Section Break** starts a new section. The distinction matters because only a Section Break lets the pages that follow use a *different* header or footer. This is a repeated trap: the wrong option claims that a Page Break changes the header or footer, which it does not (PYQ-13; TRAP-13).

Definition (Section Break). *A break that divides a document into sections, so each section can have its own page setup, including a different header and footer.*

54.5 Word feature trap: Mail Merge

Mail Merge combines a **main document** (the common letter or label) with a **data source** such as an address database, and produces many personalised copies. It is a Word feature. The trap is to confuse it with Track Changes or AutoCorrect. The reliable clue in the question is the pair “combines letters with an address database”, which points to Mail Merge and not to any other Word tool (PYQ-37; TRAP-29).

54.6 PowerPoint: the show keys

PowerPoint’s presentation shortcuts are a favourite near-neighbour set.

Shortcut	Action in PowerPoint
F5	Start the slide show from the beginning
Shift+F5	Start the slide show from the current slide
Alt+F5	Start the presentation in Presenter View
Esc	End the running slide show

The classic trap is to call **F5** the spell-check key. In PowerPoint, **F5** starts the show from the first slide; **F7** checks spelling. **Shift+F5** begins from the slide you are on, and **Alt+F5** opens Presenter View, which shows the speaker notes on the presenter’s screen while the audience sees only the slides. **Esc** ends the show but does not jump to the first slide (PYQ-40; TRAP-32).

54.7 Handouts, Slide Master, and orientation

Handouts are a print layout that places several slides on one page for the audience, usually with lined space for notes. The **Handout Master** controls the layout of handouts and notes pages.

The **Slide Master** is the design template behind the whole presentation. It controls the fonts, colours, background, and placeholder positions of every slide that uses it. Editing the Slide Master changes all dependent slides at once, which is exactly why it is used for a consistent look.

Orientation is the direction of the page. **Portrait** is taller than it is wide; **Landscape** is wider than it is tall. Slide orientation is set in PowerPoint, and notes and handouts have their own orientation setting.

54.8 PowerPoint: converting to SmartArt

SmartArt turns text into a visual diagram such as a process, cycle, or hierarchy. A **bulleted list**, a **block of text**, and **indented text** can all be converted directly to SmartArt. A **table of data** cannot be converted directly, because a table is a structured object rather than a plain text string; the Convert to SmartArt command is disabled for it. To use table content, the text must first be copied into a text box (PYQ-17).

54.9 Excel: the formula palette

Every Excel formula begins with the = sign (PYQ-38; TRAP-30). The **formula palette** — the Insert Function dialog — is the helper that lets you build a formula. It lists the function and shows each **argument** in its own box, so you can fill in the values one at a time. It is opened from the **fx** button next to the formula bar. The palette guides formula entry; it does not resize cells or change data.

Definition (Formula palette). *The Excel dialog box that lets a user select a function and enter its arguments while building a formula.*

54.10 Excel: cell references and the \$ sign

A cell reference tells Excel which cell to use. The reference type decides what happens when the formula is copied to another cell.

Reference	Type	Behaviour when copied
A1	Relative	Both column and row shift
\$A\$1	Absolute	Neither column nor row changes
\$A1	Mixed	Column fixed, row shifts
A\$1	Mixed	Row fixed, column shifts

The **\$** sign locks the part immediately after it. In **\$A\$1** both the column and the row are locked, so the reference is **absolute**: it always points to the same cell no matter where the formula is copied. **\$A1** locks the column only, and **A\$1** locks the row only; both are **mixed** references. While editing a reference, pressing **F4** cycles through relative, absolute, and mixed forms.

Example 54.10.1. *A formula in D4 reads =B4*C4. Copied down to D5, it becomes =B5*C5, because the references are relative. If instead the formula is =\$B\$4*\$C\$4, it stays =\$B\$4*\$C\$4 in every cell, because the \$ signs make both references absolute.*

54.11 Product-category traps: Word, Excel, Access, MS-DOS

JKSSB often places four familiar names together and asks which one belongs to a given category. Match each name to its exact category.

Program	Correct category
MS Word	Word processor (text documents)
MS Excel	Spreadsheet (cells and formulas)
MS Access	Database management system (tables, queries, reports)
MS-DOS	Disk Operating System (a command-line operating system)

The trap is that all four are familiar computing names. **MS Access** is a database, *not* a spreadsheet; **MS Excel** is a spreadsheet, *not* a database; and none of Word, Excel, or Access is an operating system. **MS-DOS** is the only operating system in the group.

54.12 Exam retrieval and common confusions

1. Word **F7** is spell check; **Ctrl+H** is Find and Replace; **Ctrl+K** is Insert Hyperlink.
2. **Section Break**, not Page Break, allows a different header/footer on later pages (TRAP-13).
3. PowerPoint **F5** starts from the beginning, **Shift+F5** from the current slide, **Alt+F5** is Presenter View, and **Esc** ends the show (TRAP-32).
4. A **table** cannot be converted directly to SmartArt.
5. Excel **\$A\$1** is an absolute reference; every formula starts with **=**.
6. **MS Access** is a database; **MS-DOS** is an operating system.

Example 54.12.1. *A question asks which key starts a PowerPoint slide show from the beginning. Trace the set: F5 begins the show, Shift+F5 starts from the current slide, Alt+F5 opens Presenter View, and Esc ends the show. The answer is F5. If the stem instead says “from the current slide”, the answer is Shift+F5.*

Exercises

1. State the action of F7, Ctrl+H, and Ctrl+K in MS Word.
2. Distinguish Print Layout from the other Word views.
3. Explain what Track Changes records and why it does not permanently delete the original text.
4. Distinguish a Page Break from a Section Break, and say which one allows a different header.
5. Give the PowerPoint keys for starting a show from the beginning, from the current slide, for Presenter View, and for ending the show.
6. Explain the difference between the relative reference A1 and the absolute reference \$A\$1 in Excel.
7. Classify MS Word, MS Excel, MS Access, and MS-DOS by category.

Solutions

1. **F7** opens Spelling & Grammar; **Ctrl+H** opens Find and Replace; **Ctrl+K** inserts a hyperlink.
2. Print Layout shows the document as it will appear on the printed page, with margins and headers in place. Web Layout, Outline, and Draft are the other common views and are not print-accurate.
3. Track Changes records insertions, deletions, and formatting edits, along with author and time meta-data. It marks the edits instead of applying them silently, so the original text is preserved until a reviewer accepts or rejects each change.
4. A Page Break starts a new page within the same section; a Section Break starts a new section. Only a Section Break allows a different header or footer on the following pages.
5. **F5** from the beginning; **Shift+F5** from the current slide; **Alt+F5** for Presenter View; **Esc** to end the show.
6. A1 is relative, so both its column and row shift when the formula is copied. \$A\$1 is absolute, so neither the column nor the row changes; the reference always points to the same cell.
7. MS Word is a word processor; MS Excel is a spreadsheet; MS Access is a database management system; MS-DOS is an operating system.